

Unified Champion Schools Partnership Agreement

Purpose

This agreement outlines how Special Olympics Ohio supports schools through the Unified Champion Schools (UCS) program and grant funding.

About Unified Champion Schools (UCS)

UCS promotes social inclusion by involving students with and without disabilities in shared activities. Using sports as a foundation, UCS builds a school culture of acceptance through three key areas:

Unified Sports

Whole-School Engagement

Inclusive Youth Leadership

Funding & Support from Special Olympics Ohio

Special Olympics Ohio receives support from the United States Department of Education's Office of Special Education Programs through Special Olympics North America, in addition to local funding from corporations, individual donors, and community groups. Special Olympics Ohio provides the following support to schools as they begin Unified Champion School Programming:

Year 1 Support

- Staff support & training (at no cost) for launching Unified Sports, Inclusive Youth Leadership, and Whole-School Engagement events
- Training & networking for student leaders, educators, and coaches.
- Help with fundraising to support UCS activities.
- Support with organizing Unified Sports competitions.
- Opportunities to attend state and regional youth leadership summits.

Program funding:

- Up to \$3,400 for sports uniforms/equipment (middle & high schools)
- Up to \$900 for Young Readers Club (elementary schools)
- Up to \$1,500 for Young/Junior Athletes programs (elementary schools)
- Up to \$1,000 in Unified Dream Grants for student-led projects (eligibility based on participation in SOOH fundraising)
- Access to community partnerships (e.g. YMCA, pro sports teams)
- Participation in regional, state, and national Unified competitions

Year 2 Support

- Same benefits as Year 1 (excluding new equipment funding)
- \$600 direct funding per school, to be used as determined by UCS school liaison & student team
- Limited extra support for uniforms, equipment, or special needs – contact your UCS Manager

Year 3 Support & Beyond

- Goal: School becomes self-sustaining.
- \$600 annual support for UCS activities via direct payment
- Schools achieving National Banner recognition receive support to celebrate their achievement.

Program Requirements

To receive funding, schools must commit to **at least one** of the following components. Please indicate which component you will implement by marking the checkbox(es) below. **NOTE:** These can be existing opportunities within your school or those newly created for the purpose of furthering the mission of inclusion:

Inclusive Youth Leadership

- Have a trained advisor and student club
- Hold regular meetings focused on inclusion, bullying prevention, and supporting Unified teams
- Attend a state or regional youth leadership summit

Whole-School Engagement

- Participate in UCS whole-school events or create your own school-wide events
- Promote inclusion through assemblies, recognition events, or other creative ideas
- Report activities in the UCS Team Portal.

Unified Sports, Young Athletes, and/or Junior Athletes

- Coaches must complete required UCS training in the online portal
- Coaches attend pre- and post-season meetings
- Schools must complete at least one full Unified Sports season, including a final event or tournament

Administrative Checklist

To participate, schools must:

- ___ Sign & submit this Partnership Agreement
- ___ Register in the Ohio UCS Team Portal
- ___ Complete end-of-year liaison survey (from Univ. of Massachusetts Boston)
- ___ Work with SOOH staff to get necessary program materials
- ___ Keep all program records updated in the UCS Team Portal
- ___ Complete the following **required** online trainings found here: [Special Olympics Unified Schools](#)

High School/ Middle School Sports, Whole-School Engagement, and Unified Leadership

Protective Behaviors	Special Olympics Unified Coaching
Concussions in Youth Sports	Level 1 Sport Assistant
Introduction to Special Olympics	Mentoring for Youth Leadership

Junior Athletes

Protective Behaviors	Junior Athletes Coaching Course
Concussions in Youth Sports	Introduction to Special Olympics

Young Athletes

Coaching Young Athletes	Young Athletes Onboarding Training
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***Note - If training is provided in-person by SOOH staff, E-learning is not required**

Signatures

Special Olympics Ohio

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

School

School Name _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____
UCS School Liaison Name: _____
Title: _____
Email: _____
Phone: _____

DIRECT PAYMENT INFORMATION

To Receive Check Payments

Make Checks Payable to: _____

Mailing Address: _____

To Receive ACH Payments:

Bank Name: _____ Account Number: _____

Routing Number: _____

Authorization Agreement

I hereby authorize Special Olympics Ohio to initiate credit entries, and if necessary, debit entries and adjustments for any credit entries in error to my account at the financial institution listed above. This authorization is to remain in full force and effect until Special Olympics Ohio has received written notification from me of its termination in such time and manner as to afford Special Olympics Ohio a reasonable opportunity to act on it.

This authorization agreement pertains to the direct deposit of all payroll funds and/or stipends due to me from Special Olympics Ohio into the account listed above. I agree to notify Special Olympics Ohio immediately of any changes to my account information or banking status.

Termination of Agreement

This authorization agreement may be terminated by me at any time by providing written notice to Special Olympics Ohio. By signing this form, I acknowledge that I have read and understood the terms of this authorization agreement.

Employee Signature:

- Signature:
- Date: